

THE BIG PICTURE

Borrowing Cost

Fear Index

Mid-Term Rates

Gold (Safety)

Cash Rate

WHERE THE SMART MONEY IS GOING

COMM.0.11

UTILI0.48

MATER0.54

REAL0.61

CONS.1.30

FINAN1.45

HEALT1.46

INDUS1.60

ENERG2.04

CONS.5.67

TECHN6.77

1

MU

BUY

\$932.86

-0.27%

8/10

Micron is the pure-play memory bet on AI infrastructure — HBM (high-ba

2

NVDA

BUY

\$217.55

-4.57%

8/10

The picks-and-shovels play for the AI buildout, with hyperscaler capex

3

GOOGL

BUY

\$346.59

+1.74%

8/10

Alphabet is the cheapest way to own the AI buildout while collecting s

Big options bets on MSFT (Technology) — 76.4x normal volume, P/C 0.53, largest: PUT \$518 (1401.8x OI

CRM is trading 2.2x its normal volume behind the scenes (accumulation lean)

No Congress members buying or selling stocks this week

EARNINGS COMING UP

No major earnings this week

FED & ECONOMY TODAY

GDP (Quarterly)

Date: 2026-08-28

HIGH

VIX at 14.4 — low. Options m

arket complacent ahead of sc

heduled events.

PCE Price Index [HIGH]

SHORTS GETTING SQUEEZED?

No squeeze setups detected

ARE BIG INSTITUTIONS NERVOUS?

FEELING RELAXED

Junk bonds: calm · Safe bonds: in demand · borrowing getting cheaper (calm)

WHERE MONEY IS ROTATING

Here's what's fascinating about today's flow: big money is piling into Communication Services, Utilities, and Materials — an unusual trio that tells me institutions are barbellng growth with defense.

The Comm Services bet (XLC calls outnumbering puts nearly 10-to-1) likely reflects optimism around AI monetization and the loosening antitrust posture, while Utilities and Materials are classic "infrastructure buildout" plays — think grid expansion for data centers, plus anticipation of continued industrial policy spending and potential rate cuts making bond-proxy utilities more attractive.

On the other side, the smart money is aggressively hedging Technology and Consumer Staples (both showing extreme put buying at 10x+ normal volume), which is the real tell — Tech hedging suggests worry about semiconductor export controls tightening further with China and stretched valuations, while Staples hedging hints that tariff pass-through costs and a weakening low-end consumer are becoming a real concern.

Financials and Energy getting sold is consistent with expectations of Fed cuts (squeezing bank margins) and softer oil demand plus the administration's "drill baby drill" stance keeping crude prices capped.

YOUR WATCHLIST — HOW WE FEEL ABOUT EACH

1.

SMCI

Super Micro Computer, Inc.

SMCI is a direct beneficiary of hyperscaler AI infrastructure bui

8.91/100
2.

MDB

MongoDB, Inc.

MongoDB is the leading document database for AI-native applicatio

8.46/100
3.

KTOS

Kratos Defense & Security Solu

Kratos is a pure-play on autonomous defense — unmanned aerial sys

7.79/100

DEEP DIVES — FULL REPORTS START ON PAGE 3

Pages 3–4	MU	— Micron Technology, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 5–6	NVDA	— NVIDIA Corporation	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 7–8	GOOGL	— Alphabet Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 9–10	AAPL	— Apple Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 11–12	AMZN	— Amazon.com, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 13–14	SPCX	— Procure Space ETF	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 15–16	META	— Meta Platforms, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 17–18	HOOD	— Robinhood Markets, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 19–20	MRVL	— Marvell Technology, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 21–22	PLTR	— Palantir Technologies Inc.	Hold	Conviction 5/10
Pages 23–24	TSLA	— Tesla, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 5/10

Apple Inc.
AAPL NASDAQ

Buy **\$319.70 ▲ 1.63%** 12M Price Target **\$355.00** 52-Week Range **\$225.95 – \$344.57** Market Cap **\$4.67T**

AAPL: Riding Tech Rally, All Eyes on iPhone 18 Launch

WHAT HAPPENED

- AAPL popped 1.6% to \$319.70 on heavy volume (38.5M shares, biggest of the week) — this is the fifth up day in a row and the stock is now at 79% of its 52-week range. The move looks like it's riding coattails of Nvidia's earnings and a broader "Lag 7" catch-up trade — meaning the mega-cap tech names that underperformed NVDA are finally getting bid up.
- Options flow is screaming bullish: call volume nearly 2x put volume, and someone bought 110,000 August \$317.50 calls (8x the existing open interest) — that's a big directional bet that this rally has legs into next week's Apple product event.

WHY IT MATTERS

The setup here is classic pre-event positioning — Apple typically holds its September iPhone event in ~2 weeks, and traders are front-running it. The fact that AAPL is finally participating in the AI tech rally (after lagging NVDA/MSFT all year) suggests the market is starting to give Apple credit for its on-device AI strategy, especially as regulators tighten the screws on cloud-based AI. Watch this closely: if the iPhone 18 launch actually showcases meaningful Apple Intelligence upgrades, the narrative flips from "AI laggard" to "AI privacy leader" — and that re-rating alone could push the stock to \$340+. But that unusual \$320 put buy (44x open interest!) tells me some smart money is hedging into the event, so don't chase blindly.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big overhang is the Trump administration's China tariff regime — Apple has been aggressively shifting iPhone production to India and Vietnam, but roughly 80% of iPhones still touch China somewhere in the supply chain, so any tariff escalation directly compresses margins. On the positive side, Apple got a partial exemption on semiconductors earlier this year and CEO Tim Cook's \$600B US investment pledge has bought political goodwill in DC. Also watch the DOJ antitrust case on the App Store — if the court forces Apple to open up payments, that's a direct hit to the 30% Services margin, which is the highest-multiple part of the business.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$319.70
12M Price Target	\$355.00
Upside / (Downside)	+11.0%
Market Cap	\$4.67T
FY2026E Revenue	\$425M
FY2027E Revenue	\$455M
FY2026E EPS	\$7.85
FY2027E EPS	\$8.60
Fwd P/E	40.7x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$340.00	\$325.00	\$300.00
6 Months	\$370.00	\$340.00	\$285.00
1 Year	\$400.00	\$355.00	\$270.00
2 Years	\$460.00	\$390.00	\$260.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$475.00	\$280.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$650.00	\$300.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Communication Services (+1.42%) and Consumer Discretionary (+1.15%) — both benefiting from the post-NVDA "risk-on" tech bid and hopes that the Fed's next move is a cut.

COOLING OFF: Materials and Energy are lagging on soft commodity demand and a stronger dollar — classic late-cycle rotation out of cyclical.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating out of pure AI infrastructure names (post-NVDA earnings) and into the "AI application layer" mega-caps that haven't run yet — AAPL, GOOGL, META. That's the "Lag 7" trade the Yahoo headline mentioned, and it's a direct tailwind here.

RELATED PLAY: If Apple's on-device AI narrative catches fire, the memory chip suppliers (Micron, SK Hynix) benefit because AI phones need dramatically more RAM. Also watch TSM — every iPhone chip is built there.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Just reported, still setting the tone for the entire tech tape — every mega-cap moves on its coattails right now.
- GOOGL (Alphabet): Winning the AI narrative with Gemini traction and cheaper valuation than AAPL — the "Lag 7" catch-up favorite.

AAPL CONTEXT: Apple is lagging YTD versus GOOGL and MSFT but leading the pack this week — that suggests it's finally getting its rotation moment. If it can hold above \$315, momentum traders pile in ahead of the September event. If it fails there, it's a fade back to the 50-day around \$300.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 5-8% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$305-315 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: iPhone 18 cycle disappoints OR China tariffs escalate materially OR Services growth decelerates below 10%

Hedging: Buy protective puts around product events or pair with a China-exposure short like a chip name

Palantir Technologies Inc.

PLTR NYSE

Hold	\$186.29 ▲ 0.19%	12M Price Target \$195.00	52-Week Range \$106.37 – \$207.52	Market Cap \$447.67B
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PLTR: Pentagon AI Cash Flowing, But Valuation Getting Silly

WHAT HAPPENED

- PLTR barely budged today (+0.19%) but that masks a huge week — up ~8% from Monday's low. The stock is at 79% of its 52-week range, and the narrative is 100% about Pentagon AI spending accelerating. Multiple headlines today (TheStreet, Zacks) hammered on the same theme: Palantir is the go-to name for military AI, and the "Rule of 40" (a shorthand where revenue growth % + profit margin % should exceed 40 — PLTR is reportedly crushing it) is flashing green.
- But — and this matters — Steve Eisman (the "Big Short" guy) is publicly warning about concentration risk in AI names, and an insider (Buckley) just dumped ~\$500K worth of stock last week. When smart money starts trimming into strength, pay attention.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the real story: PLTR is trading like a religion, not a stock. At a \$447B market cap on maybe \$5B of revenue, you're paying ~90x sales — meaning investors are betting \$90 for every \$1 of current sales that the future is spectacular. That only makes sense if Pentagon AI spending explodes AND commercial AI adoption keeps compounding. The good news: both trends ARE happening. The bad news: options flow shows heavy bullish call buying at \$185 expiring THIS WEEK, which is speculative fever, not conviction investing — that kind of setup often marks short-term tops. My inference: the fundamental story is real, but the entry price today is not your friend.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

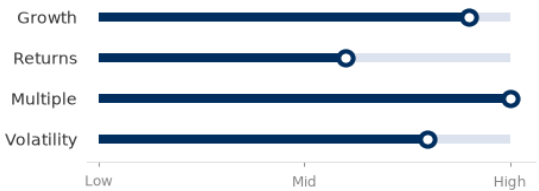
The Trump administration's AI executive orders and the ongoing defense budget expansion are direct rocket fuel for PLTR — the Pentagon has been fast-tracking AI procurement and Palantir is arguably the biggest single beneficiary of the "AI-first military" doctrine. Watch the FY2027 defense authorization bill working through Congress right now — it reportedly earmarks billions for AI/data analytics platforms, which is Palantir's home turf. The one policy risk nobody's pricing in: any federal procurement reform that mandates multi-vendor AI contracts (breaking Palantir's near-monopoly position on certain platforms) would be a real headwind — keep an eye on GAO reports about sole-source contract scrutiny.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$186.29
12M Price Target	\$195.00
Upside / (Downside)	+4.7%
Market Cap	\$447.67B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,850M
FY2027E Revenue	\$6,400M
FY2026E EPS	\$0.62
FY2027E EPS	\$0.88
Fwd P/E	300.5x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$210.00	\$190.00	\$165.00
6 Months	\$240.00	\$195.00	\$140.00
1 Year	\$275.00	\$195.00	\$120.00
2 Years	\$350.00	\$220.00	\$100.00
5 Years	\$500.00	\$280.00	\$90.00
10 Years	\$800.00	\$400.00	\$75.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Communication Services (+1.42%) and Consumer Discretionary (+1.15%) led today — money is flowing into growth/AI-adjacent names as investors digest strong earnings from mega-cap tech. Defense-AI hybrid names are quietly ripping on budget optimism.

COOLING OFF: Materials (-0.09%) and defensive sectors are lagging — classic "risk-on" positioning, which favors PLTR but also means any risk-off day hits it disproportionately.

ROTATION WATCH: Capital is rotating INTO high-beta AI names on any dip — PLTR is a prime beneficiary. But this rotation is getting crowded, and crowded trades unwind fast when sentiment shifts.

RELATED PLAY: If PLTR keeps running on Pentagon AI, the data infrastructure names benefit too — think cloud/data center plays and the traditional defense primes (Lockheed, RTX) who partner with Palantir on programs.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the AI kingmaker — every AI story starts with their chips, and Pentagon AI = more Nvidia GPUs.
- MSFT (Microsoft): Their Azure Government cloud is a direct partner/competitor to Palantir; they're winning federal AI deals too.

PLTR CONTEXT: PLTR is LEADING the pure-play AI cohort on momentum — but that's a double-edged sword. When you're the leader in a hot theme, you get the biggest inflows on the way up and the biggest outflows on the way down. It's outperforming, but from a valuation standpoint it's the most vulnerable name in the group.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

5/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 5/10 — The business is genuinely great, but the price isn't. I'm cautiously constructive, not pounding the table.

POSITION SIZE: Keep it at 1-3% max. This is a high-conviction business at a low-conviction price — size accordingly so a 30% drawdown doesn't wreck you.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for pullbacks to \$150-165 (the recent consolidation zone). Chasing at \$186 with insiders selling is bad discipline.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months, with the key catalyst being FY2027 defense budget passage and Q4 earnings confirming the government revenue acceleration.

WHEN TO BAIL: If government revenue growth drops below 40% year-over-year, or if they lose a major DoD contract renewal, get out — the multiple can't survive it.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — own less of it. If you want to get fancy, buy put options (basically insurance that pays off if the stock drops) about 15% below current price for 3-6 months out. Or pair it with a cheaper defense name so you're still exposed to the Pentagon theme without all the valuation risk.

Amazon.com, Inc.

AMZN NASDAQ

Buy	\$266.43 ▲ 3.97%	12M Price Target \$310.00	52-Week Range \$196.00 – \$287.20	Market Cap \$2.87T
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AMZN: Rips 4% as Retail Sentiment Flips Bullish

WHAT HAPPENED

- AMZN ripped +3.97% on nearly 50M shares — that's ~2x the recent daily volume, meaning this wasn't a quiet drift up, real money piled in. After 4 straight down days, this looks like a sentiment flip, likely front-running the seasonal Prime/back-to-school/holiday setup.
- Options flow is screaming bullish — 92,778 calls hit the \$265 strike (7.2x the existing open interest), which means traders are aggressively betting on more upside in the next few weeks, not hedging downside.

WHY IT MATTERS

The combination of heavy call buying + a volume spike + breaking above the recent \$262 consolidation tells me institutions are positioning for a Q4 melt-up into holiday earnings. Here's the bigger picture: with the Trump administration's tariff regime now baked into supply chains, Amazon has spent 2026 quietly re-routing sourcing to Vietnam, India, and Mexico — that pain is mostly behind them, and the market is starting to price in the tailwind of a leaner cost structure heading into peak season. The insider selling (Zapolsky, Bezos filings) is noise — Bezos sells on a scheduled 10b5-1 plan and it's been happening for years; don't over-read it. What matters more: the stock is at 77% of its 52-week range, which historically is the "breakout or fade" zone — a close above \$270 opens the door to new highs.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Two things to track: (1) the FTC antitrust case against Amazon is still grinding through court — the DOJ under the new administration has been less aggressive on Big Tech breakups than expected, which is a quiet tailwind, but a bad ruling on marketplace practices could force structural changes. (2) Tariffs on Chinese goods remain the biggest overhang — Amazon's 3P sellers (60% of retail volume) source heavily from China, so any escalation in the September trade talks hits margins directly. Also worth watching: the ongoing debate over Section 230 reform and a proposed federal data privacy bill — both could raise compliance costs but hurt smaller competitors more, actually widening AMZN's moat.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~39x forward earnings, you're paying \$39 for every \$1 of profit Amazon is expected to make next year — that's expensive vs. the S&P at ~22x, but cheap vs. where AMZN traded in 2020-2021 (60x+). The justification: AWS is growing ~18% with 35%+ operating margins, and the ads business is now a \$60B+ run-rate machine with software-like margins. If AWS re-accelerates on AI workloads, this multiple is actually cheap; if AWS decelerates, it's a trap.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Langston's | Equity Research Coverage

AI-Generated Pre-Market Brief | 2026-08-28 22:36 UTC

This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$266.43
12M Price Target	\$310.00
Upside / (Downside)	+16.4%
Market Cap	\$2.87T
FY2026E Revenue	\$745M
FY2027E Revenue	\$830M
FY2026E EPS	\$6.85
FY2027E EPS	\$8.20
Fwd P/E	38.9x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$285.00	\$272.00	\$250.00
6 Months	\$310.00	\$285.00	\$240.00
1 Year	\$340.00	\$310.00	\$230.00
2 Years	\$400.00	\$350.00	\$220.00
5 Years	\$550.00	\$450.00	\$280.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$700.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Comm Services (+1.42%) and Consumer Discretionary (+1.15%) — money is flowing back into mega-cap growth as bond yields stabilize and holiday season optimism builds.

COOLING OFF: Materials and Energy — cyclical are fading as recession chatter picks back up, and cheaper oil is a stealth tailwind for Amazon's logistics costs.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating from defensive/cyclical into mega-cap tech and consumer names — that's a direct tailwind for AMZN, which sits in both buckets (Cloud + Retail).

RELATED PLAY: If AMZN's retail engine is heating up, watch the logistics/warehouse REITs (PLD, STAG) and the ad-tech names (TTD, GOOGL) — they benefit from the same volume tailwind.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- GOOGL (Alphabet): Cloud + AI narrative running hot, and lighter regulatory heat than expected under new admin
- META (Meta Platforms): Ad spend rotating back to platforms with proven ROAS ahead of holiday

AMZN CONTEXT: AMZN was lagging its mega-cap peers over the past week but today's move suggests it's playing catch-up — that's a bullish setup because AMZN typically leads into Q4, so this could be the start of a multi-week outperformance run.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — high quality business, reasonable valuation, clear catalysts, but not screaming cheap and macro is choppy.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% — this is a core holding, not a trade. It's boring enough to size up but expensive enough that I wouldn't go over 6%.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add on dips to \$255-260. If it breaks \$270 with volume, chase a small starter but keep dry powder for pullbacks.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. The catalyst I'm waiting for is AWS re-acceleration data in Q3/Q4 earnings — that's the unlock.

WHEN TO BAIL: If AWS growth prints below 15%, or if the FTC lands a structural remedy, I'm cutting. Also bail if it breaks \$240 on high volume — that means the thesis is broken.

HEDGING: Buy cheap out-of-the-money puts 3-6 months out as insurance, or pair it against a short in a weaker retailer like WMT or TGT if you want to isolate the AWS/ads story.

Procure Space ETF

SPCX NASDAQ

Buy

\$141.50 ▲ 0.45%

12M Price Target
\$165.00

52-Week Range
\$104.83 – \$225.64

Market Cap
\$1.87T

SPCX: Space ETF Grinds Higher on SpaceX Halo Effect

WHAT HAPPENED

- SPCX ticked up 0.45% to \$141.50 — the 5th straight up day, quietly grinding higher on decent volume (~55M shares). The tape says accumulation, not euphoria. The driver: Alphabet's early SpaceX stake reportedly ballooned 100x to \$94B, which re-rates the private space market and lifts every public name attached to it.
- But there's a crack under the surface — Rocket Lab dropped 6% and Intuitive Machines fell 5% after SpaceX flagged its Iridium deal to the FCC. Translation: SpaceX is muscling into competitors' turf, and the FCC filing signals regulatory scrutiny is coming. Since SPCX holds both SpaceX-adjacent names AND competitors, this is a mixed bag.

WHY IT MATTERS

The bullish options flow (put/call ratio of 0.52 — meaning traders are buying nearly 2 calls for every put, a bet on upside) plus unusual call buying at the \$140 and \$142 strikes tells me institutions expect a breakout above \$145 in the next month. But here's the nuance: SPCX is an ETF, so it's really a proxy for the entire space sector — meaning it doesn't need any single stock to work, it just needs the *theme* to keep working. With SpaceX's private valuation now dragging the whole complex higher, and NASA about to launch a new telescope (halo effect for the sector), the flywheel is spinning. The risk is concentration — if SpaceX consolidates power (like the Iridium move), smaller names in the ETF get crushed, which caps upside even as the "theme" wins.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

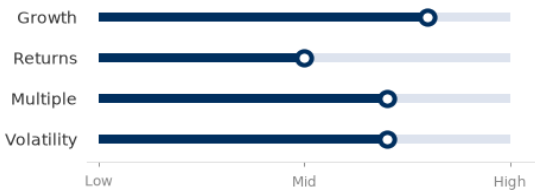
The big political tailwind: the FY2027 defense budget being debated in Congress includes a proposed ~\$30B for Space Force — up from \$29B last year — and the Golden Dome missile defense initiative is a direct catalyst for space-based sensor and launch companies in this ETF. Watch the NDAA (National Defense Authorization Act) markup in September; if space allocations survive reconciliation, that's a direct revenue pipeline for SPCX holdings like L3Harris, Iridium, and Rocket Lab. The headwind to watch: FCC scrutiny of spectrum allocation (the Iridium/SpaceX filing) — if the FCC starts blocking deals to preserve competition, it slows the sector's M&A wave, which has been a big driver of stock re-ratings.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

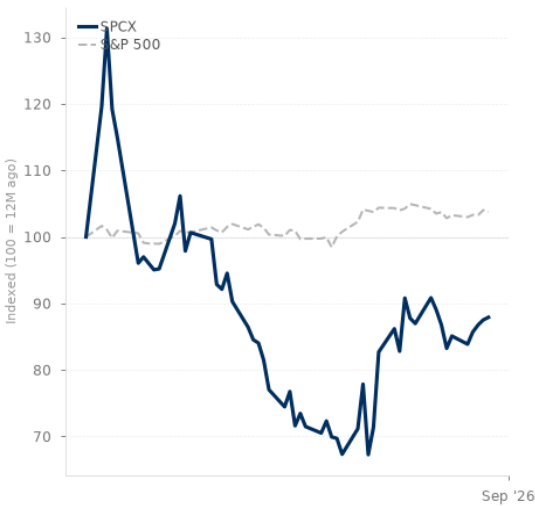
Key Data

Price (USD)	\$141.50
12M Price Target	\$165.00
Upside / (Downside)	+16.6%
Market Cap	\$1.87T
FY2026E Revenue	\$693M
FY2027E Revenue	\$940M
FY2026E EPS	(\$2.10)
FY2027E EPS	(\$1.50)
Fwd P/E	N/M

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$150.00	\$144.00	\$132.00
6 Months	\$175.00	\$155.00	\$125.00
1 Year	\$210.00	\$165.00	\$115.00
2 Years	\$260.00	\$195.00	\$100.00
5 Years	\$400.00	\$275.00	\$90.00
10 Years	\$650.00	\$400.00	\$80.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Communications Services (+1.42%) leading — that's Alphabet, Meta, satellite comms all catching a bid, which directly helps SPCX since satellite/comms names are top holdings. Consumer Discretionary also strong on IPO-market optimism, which supports the SpaceX IPO narrative.

COOLING OFF: Materials (-0.09%) and Consumer Staples weak — classic risk-on rotation, money leaving defensives.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating INTO growth/theme trades (comms, discretionary) and OUT of defensives — that's a green light for thematic ETFs like SPCX. The Alphabet/SpaceX story reignited "private tech unicorn" excitement, which flows through to space names.

RELATED PLAY: If space keeps running, the picks-and-shovels plays are the second-order winners — think semiconductor names supplying satellite chips (like Onsemi, MACOM) and defense primes with space divisions (LMT, NOC) that don't move as violently.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- RKLB (Rocket Lab): Despite today's 6% drop, still a sector leader YTD on Neutron rocket progress and DoD contracts — the pullback is a competitive worry, not a fundamental one.
- LUNR (Intuitive Machines): Down 5% today but has been a NASA lunar contract winner — moves violently on mission news.

SPCX CONTEXT: SPCX is grinding higher while its component stocks are volatile — that's the ETF working as designed (diversification smooths the ride). It's lagging the biggest single-name winners but also avoiding their crashes, which makes it the better risk-adjusted way to play the theme.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 3-5% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$132-138 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: NASA/DoD budget cuts >15% or a major launch failure across top holdings

Hedging: Pair with a short on individual overheated space names like RKLB

Robinhood Markets, Inc.

HOOD NASDAQ

Hold	\$104.26 ▼ 5.01%	12M Price Target \$115.00	52-Week Range \$63.52 – \$153.86	Market Cap \$93.74B
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HOOD: Prediction Market Ruling Slams Brakes on Rally

WHAT HAPPENED

- HOOD dropped 5% today because the Ninth Circuit (a federal appeals court covering the western US) ruled AGAINST Robinhood, Kalshi, and Crypto.com in their fight with Nevada gaming regulators. Translation: states CAN regulate prediction markets (bets on elections, sports, events) as gambling — which means Robinhood's fast-growing event contracts business just got a legal wall built around it, state by state.
- The kicker: DraftKings and Flutter (traditional sportsbooks) ripped 8-10% on the same news because a separate ruling said sports bets aren't "swaps" — meaning the prediction market platforms can't legally muscle into sports betting turf. HOOD's expansion path just got narrower.

WHY IT MATTERS

This ruling matters way more than the 5% drop suggests. Prediction markets were the sexy growth story analysts were bolting onto HOOD's valuation — the idea that Robinhood could become the "everything betting app" for elections, sports, and events. Now every state can potentially require them to get a gambling license, which is expensive, slow, and in some states (Texas, Utah) basically impossible. The bearish options flow (big put buying at \$108) suggests smart money saw this coming and expects more downside as HOOD has to guide down prediction market revenue expectations. Meanwhile, the sympathetic strength in DKNG/FLUT tells you the market thinks incumbents (licensed sportsbooks) just won a moat.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

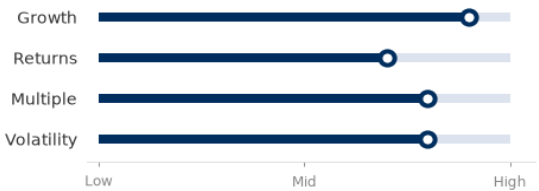
The big regulatory question now: does the CFTC (federal commodities regulator, which has been friendly to prediction markets) fight back, and can Congress pass anything clarifying federal vs state jurisdiction over event contracts? Under the current administration, the CFTC has been permissive on prediction markets, but this Ninth Circuit ruling essentially says federal permission doesn't preempt state gambling laws — that's a huge deal. Watch for HOOD to lobby hard for federal preemption legislation, but with sports leagues, tribal casinos, and state AGs all lined up against them, this is an uphill fight that could take 12-18 months to resolve.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$104.26
12M Price Target	\$115.00
Upside / (Downside)	+10.3%
Market Cap	\$93.74B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,280M
FY2027E Revenue	\$5,150M
FY2026E EPS	\$1.85
FY2027E EPS	\$2.40
Fwd P/E	56.4x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



HOOD — Robinhood Markets, Inc. | August 28, 2026

PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$118.00	\$105.00	\$92.00
6 Months	\$135.00	\$115.00	\$85.00
1 Year	\$160.00	\$120.00	\$75.00
2 Years	\$200.00	\$140.00	\$65.00
5 Years	\$300.00	\$180.00	\$50.00
10 Years	\$500.00	\$250.00	\$40.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Traditional gambling (DKNG, FLUT, MGM) — the court rulings just handed them a regulatory moat against tech disruptors. Communications Services broadly up 1.4% on ad-market strength.

COOLING OFF: Fintech disruptors trying to expand into regulated verticals — the message from courts is "stay in your lane." Crypto-adjacent names could also feel pressure if trading volumes soften.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating FROM prediction-market-adjacent fintech (HOOD, COIN) INTO licensed gambling operators (DKNG, FLUT) — that's a direct response to today's rulings and it's likely to persist for weeks.

RELATED PLAY: If prediction markets get boxed in, licensed sportsbooks capture the demand. DKNG and FLUT are the obvious plays; the second-order beneficiary is state tax revenue (indirectly benefits state-level muni bonds) and companies like GENI (Genius Sports) that provide data to licensed operators.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- DKNG (DraftKings): +10% on the ruling that sports bets aren't swaps — their regulatory moat just got reinforced
- FLUT (Flutter Entertainment): +8% same reason — FanDuel parent benefits from prediction markets being blocked from sports

HOOD CONTEXT: HOOD is LAGGING badly today against its fintech peers and getting crushed relative to the gambling names that just took its lunch. This tells you the market views today's news as a specific HOOD/Kalshi/Crypto.com problem, not a sector-wide issue — which means near-term, HOOD needs its own catalyst (strong crypto volumes, CFTC intervention, or a favorable ruling elsewhere) to break out of this range.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 2-3% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$90-95 on regulatory pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Federal court rules against CFTC preemption of state gambling laws, or crypto trading volumes collapse

Hedging: Long DKNG or FLUT as offset — they benefit from prediction market losers

Meta Platforms, Inc.

META NASDAQ

Buy \$578.02 ▲ 1.21% 12M Price Target \$675.00 52-Week Range \$520.26 – \$790.80

Market Cap \$1.47T

META: California Lawsuit Overhang Meets AI Spending Boom

WHAT HAPPENED

- META bounced back +1.2% to \$578 after yesterday's dip, but the real story is buried in the headlines: Meta called a potential California legal loss "astronomical" — that's their own word in a court filing, which is unusual and tells you the risk is real. Stock is sitting at only 21% of its 52-week range, meaning it's much closer to its yearly lows than its highs, so the market is already pricing in some pessimism.
- Alibaba apparently just crushed Meta's open-source AI model on download numbers — that matters because Zuck bet big on giving away Llama for free to build a developer moat, and if Chinese models are winning that race, the strategy needs a rethink.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I'm actually thinking: the insider selling from the CFO and Chief Legal Officer on the same day (Aug 18) right before the California lawsuit headlines got louder is a yellow flag — not damning, but executives usually know something we don't about legal exposure. The options flow is telling a mixed story: put/call ratio of 0.42 sounds bullish (way more call buyers than put buyers), but the unusual put activity at \$582.50 (28x normal open interest) means someone big is paying up for downside protection near current prices — that's a hedge against a specific event, likely the California case. Meanwhile, the Jio stake in India getting a public valuation is quietly bullish because it means a hidden asset on the balance sheet is about to get marked up. Net-net: near-term is choppy with legal headline risk, but the underlying ad business and AI capex story remain intact.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

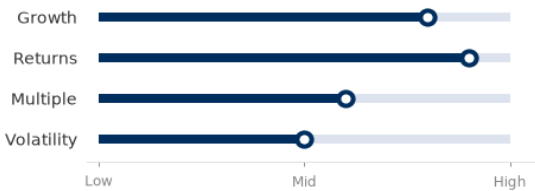
The big one: the FTC antitrust case forcing potential Instagram/WhatsApp divestiture is still winding through appeals, and the current administration has been surprisingly aggressive on Big Tech despite the pro-business rhetoric. Also watch the state-level AI regulation wave — California's SB-53 (AI transparency) and the pending federal preemption debate matter because if Congress passes a federal AI framework that overrides state laws, Meta wins big (one rulebook instead of 50). Tariff-wise, Meta is less exposed than hardware names, but their Reality Labs division sources components from Asia, so any escalation with China hits margins on the Quest line.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$578.02
12M Price Target	\$675.00
Upside / (Downside)	+16.8%
Market Cap	\$1.47T
FY2026E Revenue	\$197M
FY2027E Revenue	\$225M
FY2026E EPS	\$27.50
FY2027E EPS	\$32.00
Fwd P/E	21.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$620.00	\$590.00	\$545.00
6 Months	\$700.00	\$630.00	\$520.00
1 Year	\$780.00	\$675.00	\$490.00
2 Years	\$900.00	\$750.00	\$450.00
5 Years	\$1200.00	\$900.00	\$400.00
10 Years	\$2000.00	\$1400.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Communication Services (+1.42% today, +1.43% week) — that's Meta's sector, and it's leading the tape. Money is rotating into ad-driven platforms as recession fears fade and enterprises restart marketing budgets.

COOLING OFF: Materials and Energy are lagging — classic sign that money is moving from cyclical into growth/tech, which is a tailwind for META.

ROTATION WATCH: Consumer Discretionary popping 1.15% today but negative on the week suggests investors are picking spots, not chasing. The steady bid under Comm Services all week is the cleaner signal — institutional money is accumulating.

RELATED PLAY: If Meta's ad business is accelerating, the ad-tech infrastructure layer benefits too — think TTD (The Trade Desk) and APP (AppLovin, which is actually in today's news). Also, the AI data center buildout means AVGO, NVDA, and power/cooling plays ride the same wave.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- MSFT (Microsoft): Up 14% in a month per the headlines — AI monetization story is clearly working for them, sets a good template for META
- GOOGL (Alphabet): Direct comp on ad + AI; if GOOGL is running, META usually follows within weeks

META CONTEXT: META is lagging its mega-cap peers right now — sitting at only 21% of its 52-week range while MSFT is ripping. That's actually the setup value investors love: same secular tailwinds, temporary company-specific overhang (California case), cheaper multiple. If the legal cloud clears, META catches up fast.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — I like the risk/reward here but the legal overhang and insider selling keep me from pounding the table. If California resolves, this becomes a 9/10.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% of portfolio — big enough to matter, small enough that a legal surprise doesn't wreck your year.

ENTRY POINTS: \$555-570 on any market pullback. If it breaks \$545 on non-fundamental fear, back up the truck.

TIME HORIZON: 12-18 months — you're waiting for California resolution and for AI capex to start showing up in the P&L as revenue, not just expense.

WHEN TO BAIL: Ad revenue growth drops below 10%, adverse California ruling with clear >\$20B liability, or Zuck announces another massive Reality Labs spending increase without a revenue milestone.

HEDGING: If you're nervous about the California case, buy some downside protection (put options) around the next earnings or expected ruling date — think of it like insurance on your position. Or pair it with a short in a pricier AI name so if the whole AI trade unwinds, your hedge pays.

Micron Technology, Inc.

MU NASDAQ

Buy	\$932.86 ▼ 0.27%	12M Price Target \$1100.00	52-Week Range \$114.25 – \$1255.00	Market Cap \$1.05T
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MU: Memory King Riding CHIPS Act + AI Capex Wave

WHAT HAPPENED

- MU basically flat today (-0.27%) but the interesting tell is the options flow — massive unusual call buying at \$920, \$925, \$930 strikes expiring this week. Someone is betting big that MU pushes higher near-term, and volume was 20x normal open interest on some strikes. That's not retail — that's institutional positioning.
- The Nvidia "decoupling" story matters here — headlines note NVDA's correlation with other chip stocks has collapsed to 0.03 (basically zero). Translation: chip stocks are no longer all moving together, so MU has to prove its own case now. So far, it's holding up fine near all-time highs while Western Digital (a storage peer) got crushed 13% this month.

WHY IT MATTERS

The setup here is that MU has quietly become the "second derivative" AI trade — you can't build an Nvidia GPU without Micron's HBM memory chips stacked next to it. With MU at \$933 and near the top of its 52-week range, the market is already pricing in a lot of good news, but the CHIPS Act subsidies (Micron got ~\$6.1B from the Commerce Department for Idaho and New York fabs) mean the U.S. government is literally co-financing their capacity expansion — that's a policy tailwind you can't overstate. The WDC selloff is worth watching because it tells you the market is separating "AI memory winners" (MU with HBM) from "commodity storage" (WDC with hard drives) — that's a bullish signal for MU's premium. Near-term, the call flow suggests smart money expects an earnings catalyst or news event soon, so I'd be leaning in, not out.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

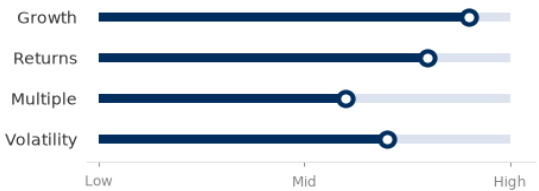
The big one is CHIPS Act 2.0 discussions in Congress — there's bipartisan momentum to extend semiconductor manufacturing subsidies beyond the original 2022 package, and if that passes, MU is one of the top three beneficiaries in the country. Also watch export controls on advanced memory to China — the Commerce Department has been tightening rules on HBM exports, which is a double-edged sword (hurts China revenue, but protects MU's tech lead and pricing power in the West). Finally, the Trump administration's tariff posture on Taiwan/Korea semiconductor imports is a wildcard — any tariffs on foreign-made memory chips would be a direct gift to MU as the only major U.S.-domiciled memory maker.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$932.86
12M Price Target	\$1100.00
Upside / (Downside)	+17.9%
Market Cap	\$1.05T
FY2026E Revenue	\$45,000M
FY2027E Revenue	\$58,000M
FY2026E EPS	\$18.50
FY2027E EPS	\$26.00
Fwd P/E	50.4x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$1050.00	\$960.00	\$850.00
6 Months	\$1200.00	\$1050.00	\$800.00
1 Year	\$1400.00	\$1100.00	\$750.00
2 Years	\$1700.00	\$1300.00	\$650.00
5 Years	\$2500.00	\$1800.00	\$500.00
10 Years	\$4000.00	\$2500.00	\$400.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Communication Services (+1.42%) and Consumer Discretionary (+1.15%) leading today — money is chasing growth again, which usually spills into semis. AI infrastructure names broadly remain the market's favorite theme thanks to relentless hyperscaler capex.

COOLING OFF: Materials and Energy fading — commodity-linked sectors losing steam as recession fears ease and money rotates to secular growth stories.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating within semis, not out of them — Nvidia decoupling from the pack means investors are getting more selective. MU is one of the "chosen" names because HBM is the scarcest resource in the AI stack.

RELATED PLAY: If MU keeps running, watch the semi equipment names (Applied Materials, Lam Research, ASML) — they sell the machines MU needs to build all these new fabs, and they benefit from every CHIPS Act dollar too.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the AI king — decoupling from chip peers means it's now its own asset class, and it pulls MU along as the memory supplier of choice.
- AVGO (Broadcom): Custom AI chips for hyperscalers plus VMware software — the diversified AI winner.

MU CONTEXT: MU is leading its direct memory peer group by a mile — WDC down 13%, while MU holds near highs. That divergence tells us the market is rewarding HBM exposure specifically, not memory broadly. As long as that narrative holds, MU stays bid.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 3-5% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$880-910 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: HBM market share loss to SK Hynix/Samsung, or memory pricing crash >25%

Hedging: Pair with a short on Western Digital (WDC) or buy protective puts 10% out of the money

Tesla, Inc.
TSLA NASDAQ

Hold	\$348.75 ▼ 1.71%	12M Price Target \$385.00	52-Week Range \$297.38 – \$498.83	Market Cap \$1.38T
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TSLA: China Recall Stings, But Robotaxi Catalyst Looms

WHAT HAPPENED

- TSLA gave back most of yesterday's pop (-1.71%), and the tape tells me why: a 3 million vehicle recall in China over door handles and driver monitoring hit the wire. That's not a small deal — China is roughly a third of Tesla's deliveries, and recalls there also raise regulatory temperature at exactly the wrong time as Beijing tightens EV standards.
- The options tape is flashing yellow — massive unusual PUT buying at \$352.50, \$355, and \$357.50 strikes (some 22x normal open interest). Translation: big money is paying up for downside protection or outright bets that TSLA closes below those levels this week. That's a bearish near-term tell.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I think is really going on: the stock is stuck in a tug-of-war. On one side, the "One Big Beautiful Bill" signed last year killed the \$7,500 federal EV tax credit as of Sept 30, 2025 — meaning Tesla lost a major demand lever, and Q3/Q4 2026 delivery comps are going to look ugly year-over-year. On the other side, the entire bull thesis has migrated to robotaxi and Optimus (humanoid robots) — so any headline about the Austin robotaxi expansion sends the stock ripping. The China recall matters because it feeds the bear narrative that Tesla's autonomy/software edge isn't as clean as advertised, right when they need regulators globally to greenlight FSD.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big one: the Trump administration's rollback of Biden-era EV mandates and the elimination of the EV tax credit is a net negative for the core auto business — competitors get hurt more, but Tesla still loses a demand tailwind. Watch the NHTSA's evolving stance on autonomous vehicles — the administration has signaled a friendlier federal framework for self-driving cars (preempting the state-by-state patchwork), which would be a massive tailwind for robotaxi scaling. Also keep an eye on China tariff negotiations — if trade tensions escalate, Tesla's Shanghai operations become a political football.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

TSLA trades at roughly 162x forward earnings — meaning investors are paying \$162 for every \$1 of profit the company is expected to make next year. For comparison, Toyota trades around 10x and even Nvidia trades around 35x. That premium ONLY makes sense if you believe robotaxi and Optimus become real revenue lines within 2-3 years — if this stays a car company, the stock is worth maybe half of here.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Langston's | Equity Research Coverage

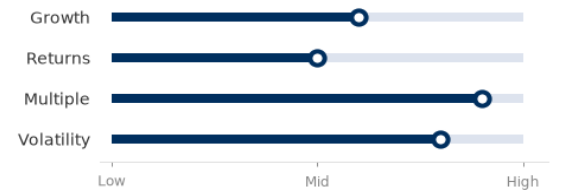
AI-Generated Pre-Market Brief | 2026-08-28 22:36 UTC

This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$348.75
12M Price Target	\$385.00
Upside / (Downside)	+10.4%
Market Cap	\$1.38T
FY2026E Revenue	\$108M
FY2027E Revenue	\$135M
FY2026E EPS	\$2.15
FY2027E EPS	\$3.40
Fwd P/E	162.2x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$380.00	\$355.00	\$320.00
6 Months	\$450.00	\$385.00	\$290.00
1 Year	\$520.00	\$400.00	\$270.00
2 Years	\$650.00	\$450.00	\$240.00
5 Years	\$900.00	\$550.00	\$200.00
10 Years	\$1500.00	\$700.00	\$180.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Communications Services (+1.42%) and Consumer Discretionary (+1.15%) are leading — money is chasing AI/mega-cap growth again, which usually helps TSLA even when its fundamentals wobble.

COOLING OFF: Materials and Energy are laggards on the 5-day — reflects softening industrial demand and lower oil, which is actually mildly bullish for EVs long-term but bearish for near-term energy sentiment.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating INTO large-cap tech/AI and OUT OF cyclicals — that's a "risk-on but selective" tape, which typically favors TSLA on quiet news days but punishes it on company-specific bad news (like today's recall).

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the robotaxi thesis, the picks-and-shovels play is NVDA (chips powering FSD) and lidar/sensor names — though Tesla infamously doesn't use lidar, so tread carefully there.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- GM (General Motors): Winning on the "boring but profitable" trade — internal combustion still prints cash and their EV losses are narrowing.
- RIVN (Rivian): Getting slammed today (-6%) on CFO departure to GE Vernova — reminder that pure-play EV names without a software story are struggling.

TSLA CONTEXT: TSLA is holding up better than Rivian and Lucid, which tells you the market still values the AI/autonomy optionality. But it's lagging the broader Consumer Discretionary sector today — meaning TSLA-specific news (the China recall) is the culprit, not macro. If it can't reclaim \$355 in the next few sessions, those unusual puts will look prescient.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

5/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 5/10 — I'm neutral here; the risk/reward is balanced with real catalysts on both sides.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% — the volatility is too high to size bigger unless you have deep conviction on robotaxi timing.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for \$310-325 — that's the lower end of the 52-week range and where the risk/reward gets more attractive. Chasing at \$350 with bearish options flow is asking to get chopped up.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — you're really waiting for robotaxi commercial proof points and Optimus updates in 2027.

WHEN TO BAIL: If auto gross margins drop below 15%, if robotaxi rollout gets pushed past 2027, or if a major FSD-related safety incident triggers federal investigation — any of those breaks the thesis.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge is buying protective put options — think of them as insurance that pays off if the stock crashes. Or pair a TSLA long with a short in a weaker EV name like Lucid to isolate the "Tesla is best-in-class" bet.

NVIDIA Corporation

NVDA NASDAQ

Buy

\$217.55 ▼ 4.57%

12M Price Target
\$265.00

52-Week Range
\$164.07 – \$236.54

Market Cap
\$5.25T

NVDA: Profit-Taking After Earnings, But Story Intact

WHAT HAPPENED

- NVDA dropped 4.57% today to \$217.55 after popping 8%+ yesterday on earnings — this is classic "sell the news" profit-taking, not a fundamental crack. Yesterday's rip means someone bought at \$228 and is now underwater, which explains the heavy put buying at \$220-225 strikes (traders hedging or betting on more downside near-term).
- The narrative got louder in both directions today: one analyst floated a \$13 TRILLION market cap (basically saying NVDA becomes 2.5x its current size), while GuruFocus questioned whether the \$315 price target holds up against a \$108B revenue quarter test. When bulls and bears both scream, volatility follows.

WHY IT MATTERS

The put/call ratio of 0.61 is technically "bearish" on the surface, but look closer — those massive put positions at \$220-225 expiring this week are almost certainly institutions hedging yesterday's gains, not directional bets against the company. What this really means: big money made money on earnings and is protecting it, which is healthy, not scary. The bigger story is that NVDA quietly became "its own market category" (per today's headline) — meaning it's no longer just a chip stock, it's the AI infrastructure benchmark, and that changes how it should be valued. Watch for the \$210 level to hold; if it does, the next leg targets \$240+ as the profit-taking clears.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

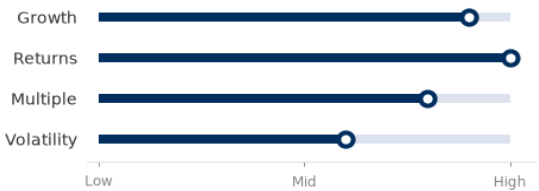
The big policy overhang remains China export controls — the Trump administration cut a deal earlier this year letting NVDA sell H20 chips to China with a 15% revenue kickback to the US government, which is unusual but keeps the China revenue spigot partially open. Watch Congress this fall for the CHIPS Act 2.0 discussions and any expansion of the AI Diffusion Rule, which could either open or close markets in the Middle East and Southeast Asia where NVDA has been signing sovereign AI deals (Saudi, UAE). Also on the radar: the federal AI infrastructure spending baked into the FY2027 budget — if that clears, NVDA gets a direct pipeline into DoD and DOE supercomputing contracts.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$217.55
12M Price Target	\$265.00
Upside / (Downside)	+21.8%
Market Cap	\$5.25T
FY2026E Revenue	\$205M
FY2027E Revenue	\$268M
FY2026E EPS	\$4.45
FY2027E EPS	\$6.20
Fwd P/E	48.9x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$235.00	\$222.00	\$200.00
6 Months	\$265.00	\$240.00	\$185.00
1 Year	\$315.00	\$265.00	\$170.00
2 Years	\$400.00	\$320.00	\$150.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$425.00	\$130.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$550.00	\$100.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Communication Services (+1.42%) leading today — Meta and Google benefit from the same AI story as NVDA but with less earnings volatility. Consumer Discretionary also strong, suggesting risk-on tone despite NVDA weakness.

COOLING OFF: Materials slightly red; Energy bouncing but 5-day still negative — the "old economy" trade isn't catching a bid, which is actually bullish for tech/AI leadership continuing.

ROTATION WATCH: Money isn't leaving AI — it's rotating WITHIN AI. Today's NVDA weakness is likely funding buys in the AI-adjacent names (hyperscalers, power companies, data center REITs) that benefit from the same theme with less crowded positioning.

RELATED PLAY: If you want NVDA exposure without the single-stock risk, look at the picks-and-shovels one level deeper — Vertiv (VRT) for data center cooling, Constellation Energy (CEG) for the nuclear power that AI needs, and TSM which actually makes NVDA's chips.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- AVGO (Broadcom): Custom AI silicon for hyperscalers — the "if you can't beat NVDA, hire Broadcom" trade.
- META (Meta Platforms): Biggest NVDA customer, and their ad business monetizes the AI spend directly.

NVDA CONTEXT: NVDA is DOWN today while the broader tech tape is UP — that's short-term profit-taking, not a leadership change. NVDA is still 74% of its 52-week range and up massively YTD; a 4.5% pullback after an 8% earnings pop is just the market breathing.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — Pounding the table on the multi-year story, cautiously optimistic on the next 30 days given today's technical damage.

POSITION SIZE: 5-8% of a growth portfolio — this is a core holding, not a trade. It's big enough to matter but not so big that a 20% drawdown ruins your year.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd nibble at \$210-215, back up the truck sub-\$200. Don't chase above \$225 in the short term — let the profit-takers finish.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months, with the next catalyst being Q3 hyperscaler capex guidance in late October and any China policy news.

WHEN TO BAIL: If a hyperscaler guides capex DOWN by more than 10%, or if China policy reverses hard, cut position in half. Full exit if forward revenue guide comes in below 30% growth.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — own less. If you're nervous, trim 20% here and re-buy on a pullback. Fancy version: buy 6-month puts 15% out of the money as portfolio insurance, roughly 2-3% of position value.

Alphabet Inc.
GOOGL NASDAQ

Buy	\$346.59 ▲ 1.74%	12M Price Target \$385.00	52-Week Range \$206.20 – \$408.61	Market Cap \$4.24T
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GOOGL: Bounces Back as AI Capex Debate Heats Up

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock snapped a 3-day slide, popping 1.74% to \$346.59 on solid volume — this looks like a bounce-back after Comm Services as a whole caught a bid (+1.42%), and options desks lit up with unusual call buying (people betting on the stock going UP) at the \$345 and \$350 strikes. Translation: someone with real money thinks this rebound has legs into September.
- The Marvell earnings blowup (-10% on weak guidance) is the interesting sideshow — it's making investors nervous that the "AI capex tsunami" (massive spending on AI chips and data centers) might be peaking. GOOGL going UP while a chip supplier tanks tells you the market is separating the AI *spenders* (Google, MSFT) from the AI *suppliers* — and right now, being a spender with your own cash flow is the safer trade.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I think is really going on: the market is starting to distinguish between AI winners with real cash flow (GOOGL, META) versus companies that just *sell picks and shovels* to the AI boom (Marvell, some chip names). That's a subtle but important rotation — and GOOGL sits on the right side of it because Search + YouTube fund the AI buildout without needing debt or dilution. The insider "OTHER" transactions from Walker and Pichai look like scheduled 10b5-1 stuff (pre-planned sales, not panic selling), so I wouldn't read the "bearish" insider signal too literally. Bigger picture: with the DOJ antitrust remedy phase still unresolved and Washington increasingly viewing US Big Tech as a strategic asset against China, the political winds are quietly shifting from "break them up" to "let them compete with Beijing."

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

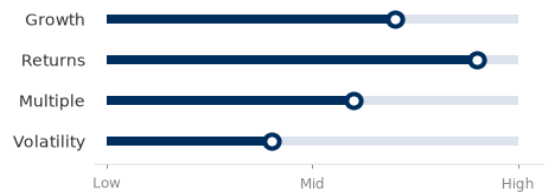
Two things to watch: (1) the DOJ antitrust remedy in the Search case — the July 2026 ruling avoided forced Chrome divestiture but data-sharing requirements are still being negotiated, and any softening here is a direct catalyst; (2) the AI infrastructure and permitting reform push in Congress — bipartisan interest in fast-tracking data center construction and power grid upgrades directly benefits Google Cloud's expansion plans. The Trump administration's AI Action Plan has been notably friendlier to US hyperscalers (the giant cloud/AI companies) than the Biden-era export control regime, framing them as national champions — that's a quiet but real tailwind that isn't in the stock price yet.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$346.59
12M Price Target	\$385.00
Upside / (Downside)	+11.1%
Market Cap	\$4.24T
FY2026E Revenue	\$415M
FY2027E Revenue	\$470M
FY2026E EPS	\$9.85
FY2027E EPS	\$11.40
Fwd P/E	35.2x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$365.00	\$352.00	\$325.00
6 Months	\$400.00	\$375.00	\$300.00
1 Year	\$440.00	\$385.00	\$280.00
2 Years	\$520.00	\$430.00	\$270.00
5 Years	\$750.00	\$550.00	\$300.00
10 Years	\$1200.00	\$800.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Communication Services (+1.42%) and Consumer Discretionary (+1.15%) — money is flowing back into growth/AI beneficiaries as bond yields stabilized this week. The "AI capex is a credit boom" thesis is bringing generalist investors back to hyperscalers.

COOLING OFF: Materials and Energy are flat-to-down over 5 days — classic "risk-on rotation" where defensive/cyclical names lose to growth. Also, AI *suppliers* (chip names post-Marvell) are getting scrutinized on whether guidance can keep up with expectations.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating from "AI picks-and-shovels" (chips, networking) INTO "AI monetizers" (GOOGL, META, MSFT) because those companies have real revenue from AI now, not just hopes. That's exactly why GOOGL bounced while Marvell got smashed.

RELATED PLAY: If GOOGL keeps working, the second-order winners are data center REITs (EQIX, DLR) and power/utility names supplying hyperscaler campuses — Google's capex has to land somewhere physical.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- META (Meta Platforms): Similar setup — AI monetization already showing in ad revenue, cheaper than MSFT, benefits from same policy tailwinds.
- MSFT (Microsoft): The other AI monetizer, though Trefis flagged today it may have "run ahead of its AI payoff" — that valuation concern is exactly why GOOGL looks better relatively.

GOOGL CONTEXT: GOOGL is holding its own but not leading — it's the "value" name in the mega-cap AI trade, which means it lags on euphoric days but holds up better on fear days. That's actually the profile you want for a core position — you're getting AI exposure without paying the crazy premium.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 5-8% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$335-342 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Forced Chrome/Android divestiture ruling OR cloud growth drops below 20%

Hedging: Small put spread or pair against an overheated pure-play AI name like Marvell/AMD

Marvell Technology, Inc.

MRVL NASDAQ

Hold	\$216.62 ▼ 10.28%	12M Price Target \$240.00	52-Week Range \$61.44 – \$329.88	Market Cap \$194.68B
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MRVL: Guidance Miss Overshadows Record Quarter, AI Story Intact

WHAT HAPPENED

- MRVL just posted RECORD earnings but the stock cratered 10% because forward guidance for fiscal 2028 came in softer than Wall Street wanted — this is a classic "great quarter, but what have you done for me tomorrow" reaction. The kicker: their custom Google chip deal (Axion) has timing that's pushed further out than investors expected, and when a stock is priced this richly, any delay gets punished brutally.
- Options flow is flashing bearish — the put/call ratio is 0.62 (meaning traders are aggressively buying downside protection) and there's unusual activity in \$215-225 puts expiring soon, so smart money is betting on more downside or hedging existing positions.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what today really means: the AI trade is entering a phase where "beating estimates" isn't enough anymore — you have to beat AND raise guidance meaningfully, or you get taken to the woodshed. MRVL's Google Axion timing slip suggests that hyperscaler custom-silicon revenue is lumpy and hard to forecast, which introduces a new risk premium into the stock. That said, the bigger picture is unchanged: Amazon, Google, and Microsoft are all racing to build their own AI chips to avoid paying Nvidia's tax, and MRVL is the picks-and-shovels play for that. This selloff is more about expectations resetting than the thesis breaking — but it also means the "easy money" phase of this trade is over, and you now need to be selective on entries.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

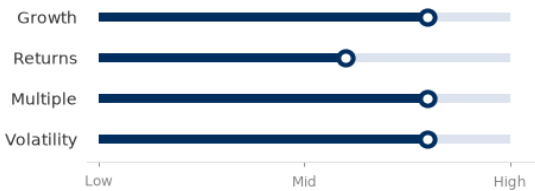
The big political tailwind here is the CHIPS Act (which handed out billions in subsidies to boost US semiconductor production) and the Trump administration's ongoing push on China export controls — both help MRVL because they make US-designed custom silicon more strategically valuable to hyperscalers who need "clean" supply chains. Watch for any updates on the proposed AI Diffusion Rule expansion (which restricts advanced chip exports) — if it tightens further, it could actually help MRVL by locking in domestic hyperscaler demand, but if there's a China trade thaw, it removes some of the scarcity premium. Also worth tracking: federal AI infrastructure spending discussions in the FY2027 budget cycle, where data-center buildout tied to government cloud contracts (AWS GovCloud, Azure Government) flows indirectly to MRVL through hyperscaler orders.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$216.62
12M Price Target	\$240.00
Upside / (Downside)	+10.8%
Market Cap	\$194.68B
FY2027E Revenue	\$8,200M
FY2028E Revenue	\$10,400M
FY2027E EPS	\$2.85
FY2028E EPS	\$3.80
Fwd P/E	76.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$240.00	\$220.00	\$195.00
6 Months	\$285.00	\$240.00	\$180.00
1 Year	\$330.00	\$260.00	\$170.00
2 Years	\$420.00	\$310.00	\$160.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$400.00	\$180.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$550.00	\$200.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Communication Services (+1.42%) leading today — money is rotating toward mega-cap platforms with defensible AI monetization stories. Consumer Discretionary also firm on resilient spending data.

COOLING OFF: Semiconductors broadly caught in a "show me" moment — after MRVL's guidance miss, the group is being re-underwritten on realistic (not fantasy) growth assumptions.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is moving from AI infrastructure suppliers back toward AI application/platform layers (Google, Meta, Microsoft) because investors want exposure to AI without the capex-cycle risk. That's a subtle but real headwind for names like MRVL, AVGO, and even NVDA short-term.

RELATED PLAY: If MRVL's setup gets ugly, the pair trade is long AVGO (which has more diversified custom silicon customers and better earnings visibility) or long the hyperscalers themselves (GOOGL, AMZN) — they benefit from lower chip supplier pricing power.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- AVGO (Broadcom): Winning the custom-silicon narrative war — investors see them as the "safer" MRVL with bigger scale and Apple/Google anchor customers locked in.
- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the AI king, and any weakness in custom-silicon competitors like MRVL actually reinforces the thesis that displacing Nvidia is harder than it looks.

MRVL CONTEXT: MRVL is now LAGGING the AI semi peer group after today, which tells us the market views them as the marginal/second-tier player in custom silicon versus AVGO. Until they prove Amazon Trainium 3 and Google Axion ramp on schedule, they'll trade at a discount to Broadcom — that gap is the opportunity if they execute, or the value trap if they don't.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 2-4% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$200-210 on further pullback

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Loss of Amazon Trainium or Google Axion silicon socket, or hyperscaler capex cuts

Hedging: Pair with a short on a richer AI name like AVGO or buy protective puts

The following stocks were identified by screening a curated universe against the current watchlist's investment themes, today's macro environment, and smart-money signals. Scores reflect theme alignment, momentum, valuation, and institutional flow. These are research leads — not investment advice.

1	SMCI	Super Micro Computer, Inc. Semiconductors	8.9/10	BUY
Price: \$37.08 · 1M: +44.3% · P/S: 0.6x · Cap: \$24.0B				
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
OPT:BULL			INS:NEUT	
			INST:BULL	
2	MDB	MongoDB, Inc. AI & Machine Learning	8.5/10	BUY
Price: \$446.62 · 1M: +39.1% · P/S: 13.8x · Cap: \$35.9B				
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
OPT:BULL			INS:NEUT	
			INST:BULL	
3	KTOS	Kratos Defense & Security Solutions Defense Technology	7.8/10	BUY
Price: \$52.00 · 1M: +18.5% · P/S: 6.4x · Cap: \$9.8B				
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
OPT:NEUT			INS:NEUT	
			INST:BULL	
4	CACI	CACI International, Inc. Defense Technology	8.2/10	WATCH
Price: \$628.20 · 1M: +28.8% · P/S: 1.5x · Cap: \$13.9B				
■ Monitor for pullback to \$560 entry				
OPT:BULL			INS:NEUT	
			INST:BEAR	
5	GTLB	GitLab Inc. AI & Machine Learning	8.6/10	BUY
Price: \$44.87 · 1M: +31.9% · P/S: 7.5x · Cap: \$7.6B				
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
OPT:BULL			INS:NEUT	
			INST:BULL	